INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

BUSINESS FINANCE SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Accurate – Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the role and responsibilities of financial management personnel.
2. Explain professional designations in the field of business finance (e.g., CF, CFA, CCM, CTP, CFM, etc.).
3. Discuss employment opportunities in the finance industry.
4. Ascertain employee's role in meeting organizational goals.
5. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the controller at BRIGHTLOOP, a fast-growing software company. The CEO (judge) wants your recommendation on how to build the company's finance team.

BRIGHTLOOP's sales grew from $6 million to $14 million in two years. The company plans to raise $20 million from investors next year. Right now, you are the most senior finance employee. The CEO (judge) is a software engineer with no finance background and is considering two options:

- **Option A:** Hire a full-time chief financial officer (CFO). Salary: $225,000, plus 25% for benefits and payroll taxes.
- **Option B:** Hire a part-time "fractional" CFO for $12,000 per month, and hire a full-time financial analyst. Analyst salary: $85,000, plus 25% for benefits and payroll taxes.

The CEO (judge) wants you to:

- Explain the roles and responsibilities of a CFO, controller, treasurer and financial analyst.
- Calculate the total yearly cost of each option.
- Explain which professional designations to look for when hiring, and why they matter.
- Explain how each finance role helps BRIGHTLOOP reach its goal of raising $20 million.
- Present your recommendation in a way a non-finance CEO will understand.

You will present your recommendation to the CEO (judge) in a meeting in the CEO's office. The CEO (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the CEO's (judge's) questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Investors will ask who's running our finances. Will a part-time CFO hurt their confidence?
2. What's the difference between what you do as controller and what a CFO would do?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the role and responsibilities of financial management personnel.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain professional designations in the field of business finance (e.g., CF, CFA, CCM, CTP, CFM, etc.).	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Discuss employment opportunities in the finance industry.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Ascertain employee's role in meeting organizational goals.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Accurate** Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	

Answer key:

- Option A: $225,000 × 1.25 = $281,250.
- Option B: $144,000 + $106,250 = $250,250.
- Option B is $31,000 less per year.